



the basic
argument



**allowable
evils**

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

This argument simply replaces (5)

with (5^*) . But this argument is

which are supposed to follow from

some changes to the premises

(5*)

invalid. To fix it, we need to make

1. If God exists, then God is omnipotent.
2. If something is omnipotent, it can do anything.
3. If God exists, then God can do anything. (1,2)
4. If God exists, then God is wholly good.
- 5*. If something is wholly good, it always eliminates as much pointless evil as it can.
6. If God exists, then God eliminates as much pointless evil as God can. (4,5)
7. If God exists, then God eliminates all pointless evil. (3,6)
8. If God exists, then there is no pointless evil. (7)
- 9*. Some pointless evil exists.

C. God does not exist. (8,9)

THE ARGUMENT FROM POINTLESS EVIL

condition does not follow from

But this is not quite enough; the

(8) and (9). ■

argument is still invalid, since the

To fix this, we need to strengthen

premise (9).

Let's call this the 'argument from

pointless evil.

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$$(5 *) \cdot$$

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Let's call this their argument from

pointless evil.

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evil as God said. (4,5)

2. If something is on it,

do anything. (1,2)

6. If God exists, then God



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prints even as it can.

4. If God exists, then God is

it can do anything.

3. If God exists, then God can

it always initiates as much



(3,6)

5*. If something is wholly good,

1. If God exists, then God is

9*. Some principles exist.

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8. If God exists, then there is

no point less evi1. (7)

7. If God exists, then God



C. God does not exist. (8,9)



So attention naturally focuses on premise (5).



as in the visit card.

good, it always reminds

5. If something is wholly



2: If something

is important, it

any possible



cairibiriing about



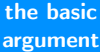
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There are two especially important arguments against belief in God.



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evivivis. exisits.

9*. Some points less

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